

was evidently was an old acquaintance of mine. I could tell by the excited manner in which he shouted my name and was now pumping my hand. Right. Thankfully, I had installed the Socialite plugin into my Odin for just such occasions (of which there were many). As Odin threw up relevant metadata around this Ravendra (apparently my classmate from Std 5), I flooded him with his life's own factoids and made pleasantries. "Of course I remember the school picnic where you ate a sandwich filled with sand! Ha ha... and how is the missus?... oh look at the time, I have to rush, yes of course I will see you at the reunion next month!" I gave him my ID where all spam goes to die and continued my way to KFC. Each hospitality center has a bright multicolored globe next to its name. If you intend to use its services, you only need to fix your gaze on the globe for 5 unblinking seconds — I did and a menu was thrown up by the sidewalk — I chose a burger and some cold coffee to go. Odin did the electronic transaction and showed me the waypoint where I could collect my food in two minutes... Two minutes later, munching on my burger, slurping down my coffee, I headed to my destination. The brunch was much needed: it both woke me up and served as a good source of energy to recharge my OdinVision. Junk food that tasted good and didn't put on much fat — now that's progress one could get behind! Odin alerted me to Mr Green's ETA; he would be here any minute now. I spent some time looking over the building where Mr Green would make his delivery. It was a hospital for the elderly; it used to be a school until a long-standing land dispute was resolved in the hospital's favour in 2040. This wasn't my general knowledge on the city speaking; rather it was Odin, thank-

A MOMENT OF CLARITY (AKA YEH WRITER KYA BAKWAAS KAR RAHA HAI)

window into the virtual, layering it upon the real. Think Google Maps, in elevation mode being projected onto your surroundings... now slowly add in the other Google services and crowd sourced offerings such as Wikipedia for a taste of the wonderful and scary world that is to be. In this story, we have miniaturized Glass into a soft-lens. How is the lens powered, you ask? Through the power of love, but naturally...

Smart Houses: Take your garden-variety smart white goods (televisions, refrigerators, microwaves...) and bring them all together under a benevolent dictator, i.e. a home server, throw together a wireless local-area network that would allow the dictator to listen in and order around the goods and you have a smart house in the making. Granted, the 'smart' televisions et al, are currently a misnomer, but we give it another three decades for the likes of Samsung and LG to figure it out...

The Gadget: Or the nano-machine delivery pills... this one is more fact-ion than fact. Think Metal Gear Solid — no wait, don't... The fact: researchers are exploring how human tissues, cells, and mechanical activities such as walking and the beating of the heart can power tiny, tiny machines. For example: using the host's heartbeats to power his or her pacemaker, or powering a hearing aid using a pool of natural ions generated in the human ear... Batteries powered by the human gait, micro-fibers woven into your clothes that store and release micro-watts, and so on. The fiction: reduce everything to a nano scale and inject the machines into the human body. These nano-machines would talk to each other over a very, very local network and hopefully play nice and not explode your heart or melt your brain. Makes you feel all warm inside, doesn't it?

lessly serving me data on the building I was so evidently keen on. The courier arrived, carrying a suspiciously similar package in hand. I cut him off, showed him my ID and explained the situation. Unfortunately, Mr Green was from out of town and was both new to the area and to the local lingo. Thankfully, OdinVision's translation soft-

ware could translate just about any speak into just about any other language (exception: political speeches). We communicated haltingly, I made a mess of his dialect but he got the gist of the mix-up. I exchanged the granny panties for The Package and walked back to my car with a smile. This was going to be a good day, after all.... 



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